

Renewables: the pace, not the target

The question

Every member state has a renewable-share target for 2030. Targets are a statement of intent. This asks a different question: at the speed each country has actually managed over the last five years, where does it land in 2030?

Why it matters for a supervisor

A transition plan that assumes the national grid decarbonises on schedule is assuming something the last five years of data may not support. The pace is observable; the target is not evidence.

The answer, in one line

7 of 27 member states reach 42.5% by 2030 at their own pace.

Method

Data

Eurostat nrg_ind_ren, share of renewable energy, balance REN, pulled live from the public dissemination API. No key, no scraping, no manual download.

Calculation

For each member state: take the latest observed year, measure the average annual change over the five years ending there, and carry that pace forward to 2030.

Then compare with the pace that would be required from the latest year.

The yardstick

42.5% is the EU AGGREGATE target in RED III. It is not a national obligation.

It is used here as one common ruler so the countries can be compared. National contributions differ and are not in this dataset. Stating otherwise would make the whole comparison a false premise.

Check

tests/test_renewables.py covers the arithmetic on a fixed series, including a falling share, which must project downwards rather than be clipped at zero.

Result

The gap is in the pace, not in the level

The eight furthest from the yardstick need between 4.6 and 5.2 points a year. None of them has managed anything close over the last five years.

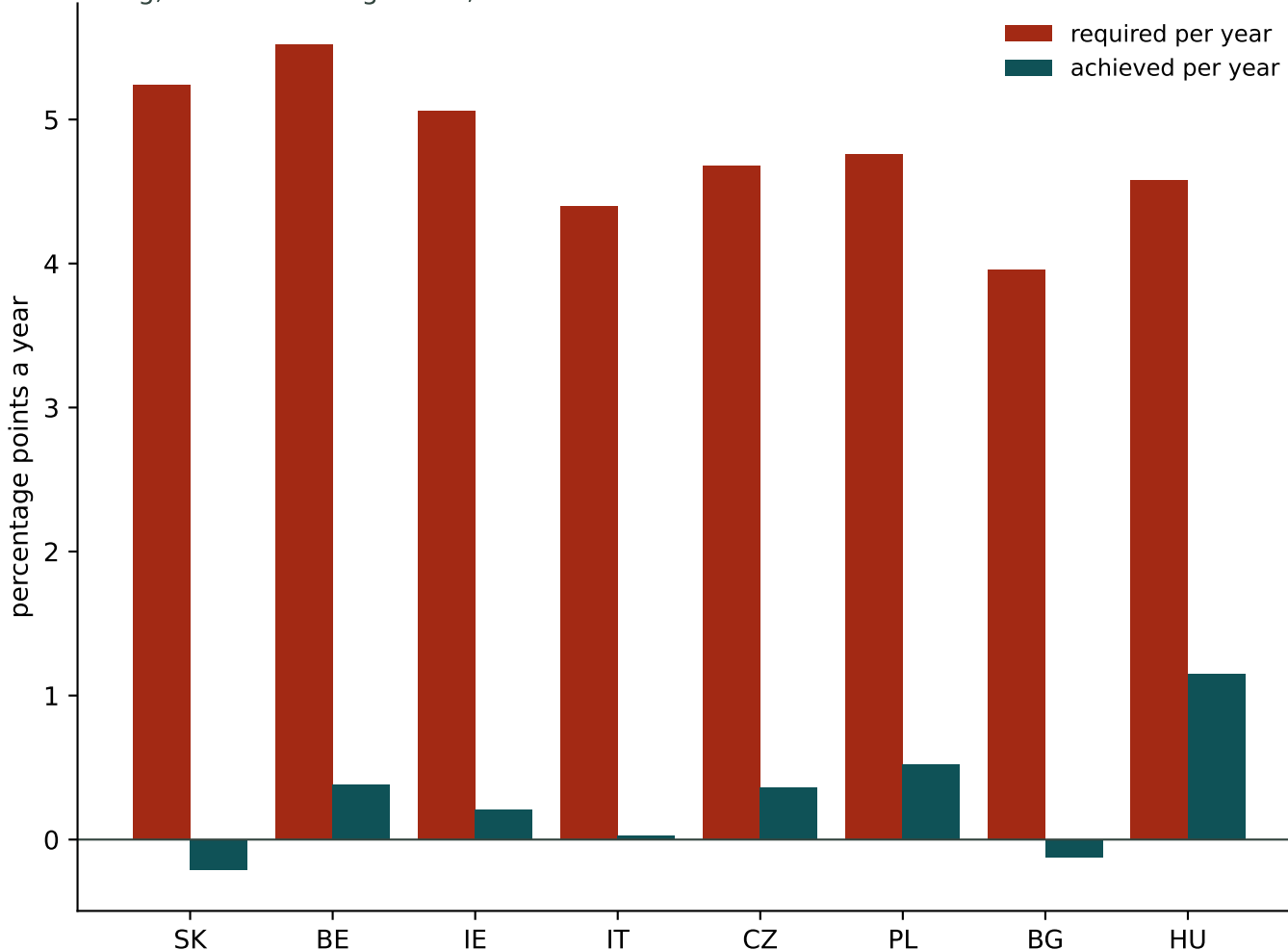
SK is going backwards

Its share fell 0.21 points a year over the window, from a 16.3% base.

Italy is flat

+0.03 points a year against 4.40 required.

Not falling, but not moving either, from a 20% base.



Limits, and what I would do next

A linear pace is the crudest possible model

Deployment is lumpy: one offshore wind farm moves a small country's number. Five years smooths that, it does not remove it.

The denominator moves too

The share is renewables over gross final consumption. A country can gain share by consuming less, which is not the same achievement as building capacity.

The yardstick is an aggregate

Comparing each state against 42.5% is a ruler, not an assessment of compliance.

The honest next step is the national contributions in the NECPs, which are not machine-readable in this dataset.

What I would build next

Weight each country by gross final consumption to get the EU aggregate path, and test whether the aggregate reaches 42.5% even when most members do not. That is the number that actually matters, and it is not the average of these.